

PHYSICIAN CLINICAL DOCUMENTATION — SOAP NOTE

Patient Name:	Jordan Lee	Patient ID:	P002
Date of Birth:	09/23/1989 (Age 37)	Date of Service:	September 24, 2026
Insurance Plan:	Aetna Choice POS	Coverage Status:	ACTIVE
Attending:	Dr. Marcus Thorne, MD (Family & Sports Medicine, NPI: 1472839102)	Facility:	Oakridge Ambulatory Care Center, Suite 102

[S] SUBJECTIVE (HISTORY & SYMPTOMATOLOGY)

Chief Complaint: Moderate low back stiffness and pain for 9 weeks.

History of Present Illness (HPI): 37-year-old male presents with 9 weeks of intermittent axial low back pain following home remodeling. Pain rated 5/10 on average. Localized to the lumbosacral junction without distal radiation below the knee. No numbness, paresthesias, weakness, or constitutional symptoms. Patient reports taking occasional over-the-counter Ibuprofen. **Patient explicitly documents that no formal physiotherapy was tried** to date due to work obligations.

[O] OBJECTIVE (EXAM & PHYSICAL THERAPY RECORD)

Vital Signs: BP 118/74 mmHg, HR 68 bpm, Temp 98.6°F, BMI 26.0.

Musculoskeletal Exam: Normal unassisted gait. Mild midline lumbar tenderness over L3-L4. No palpable spasm. Lumbar flexion 65° without neurological symptoms.

Neurological Exam: Motor 5/5 in all lower extremity groups bilaterally. Sensation intact to light touch in all dermatomes (L2-S1). Reflexes 2+ symmetrical bilaterally. Negative bilateral straight leg raise.

Documented Conservative Therapy: **No physiotherapy attempted (0 weeks).** Patient has not participated in any structured physical rehabilitation program.

[A] ASSESSMENT (DIAGNOSES & PRIOR AUTH POLICY EVALUATION)

Primary Diagnoses:

- Non-specific mechanical low back pain (ICD-10 M54.50)
- Lumbar myofascial strain (ICD-10 S39.012A)

Prior Authorization Guideline Criteria Evaluation:

- Active Insurance Coverage: **MET** (Aetna POS active)
- Symptom / Pain Duration Threshold (≥ 6 weeks): **MET** (9 weeks documented)
- Trial of Supervised Physical Therapy (≥ 6 weeks): **NOT MET** (0 weeks attempted)

Recommendation: **DENY** — Failure to complete prerequisite trial of supervised physical therapy (minimum 6 weeks required prior to advanced imaging).

[P] PLAN (IMAGING STUDY, INTERVENTIONS & ORDERS)

- 1. Conservative Management:** Referral issued for 6-week course of supervised outpatient physical therapy emphasizing core stability and biomechanics.
- 2. Advanced Imaging:** Lumbar MRI deferred pending completion of conservative therapy trial.
- 3. Pharmacology:** Naproxen 500mg BID with food PRN.
- 4. Follow-up:** Clinic re-evaluation in 6 weeks following physical therapy completion.

Electronically Signed By:

Dr. Marcus Thorne, MD (Family & Sports Medicine, NPI: 1472839102) • Date: September 24, 2026
15:42 EST